

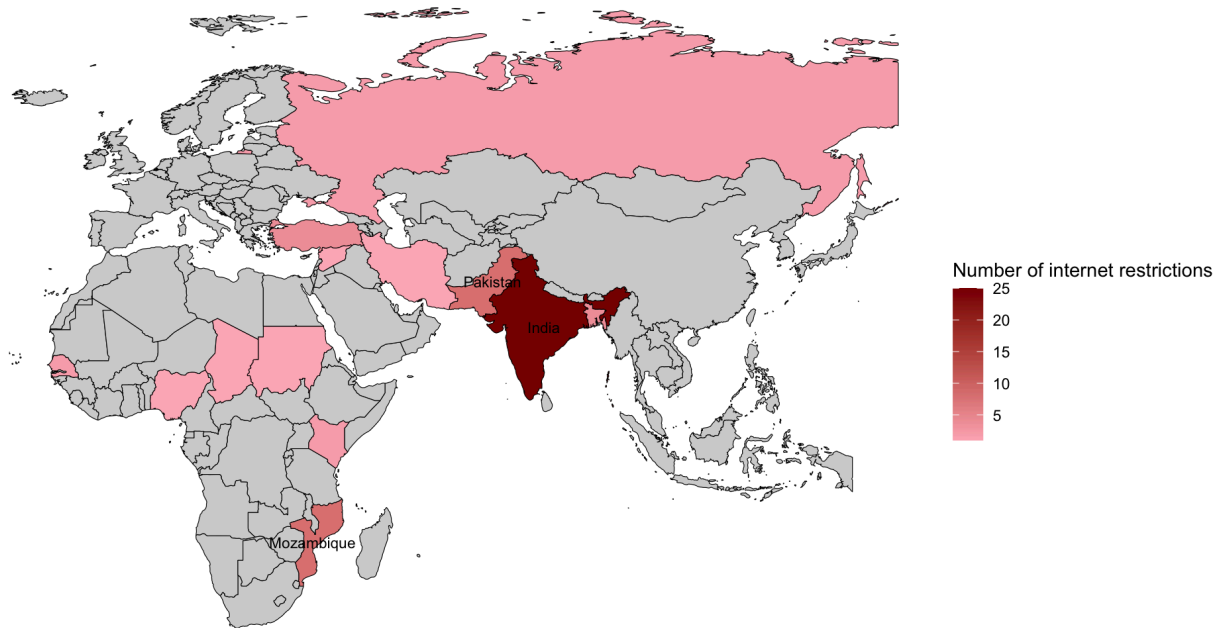
For the final data narrative, I would like to use a dataset that you can access [here](#), which I found from Data Is Plural (see [here](#)). This dataset was compiled by Surfshark researchers who have been monitoring government-imposed internet restrictions since 2015. Their data is from news articles, NetBlocks (a global internet monitor), AccessNow (a non-profit focused on global internet censorship), and other sources. The data includes the start and end dates of a given censorship, its duration in hours, whether it was related to elections, political turmoil, protests, or internet laws, and if it affected certain social media apps (Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Instagram, Telegram, WhatsApp), local internet, or nationwide internet.

This dataset is interesting because you can see geographic trends of internet censorship and delve deeper into the reasons behind them and what particular apps were banned. This data could create a narrative about the state of a country and its people if the government is heavily censoring the internet. I also think it would be interesting to see if certain apps are particularly penalized, which could show that some platforms are engaged more with content that upsets governments, such as activism and independent journalism, and perhaps this varies across countries.

I would like to explore the analysis avenue of what happened in South Asia in 2024, as India really stands out in the number of internet restrictions it imposed that year, which were largely due to protests and elections. Furthermore, Pakistan stands out as the top social media restrictor, particularly on Twitter, Instagram, and Facebook, so it would be interesting to see what was happening on these platforms that provoked government action to shut them down.

*Note about charts: They are clearly very unpolished, I aim to refine them in Adobe Illustrator, particularly with the country labels for the faceted charts, which were a headache to deal with in R. Also, for my “one great chart,” I was having difficulty implementing a shapefile without the small islands, which you had advised- I was thinking of just deleting the small islands around Africa, Europe, and South America in Adobe?

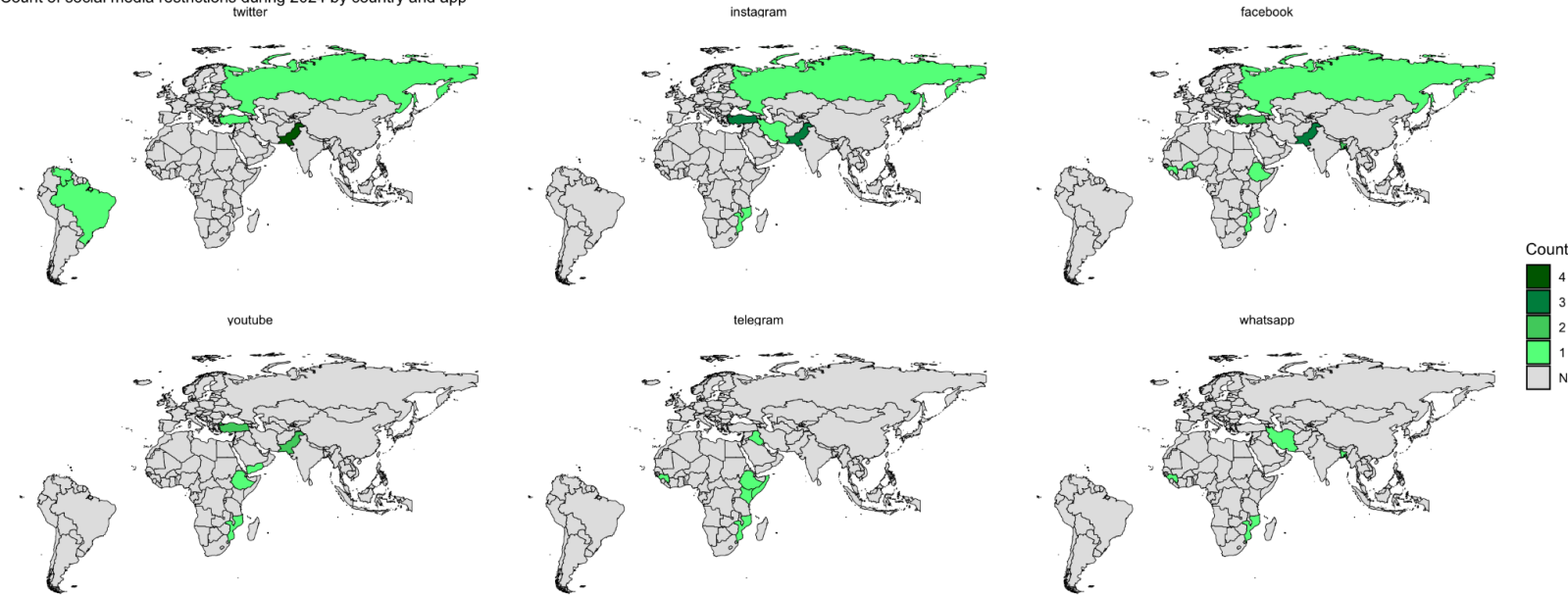
India leads in internet censorships imposed in 2024
Number of newly imposed internet restrictions by country in 2024



Source: Surfshark

Pakistan dominates social media restrictions in 2024

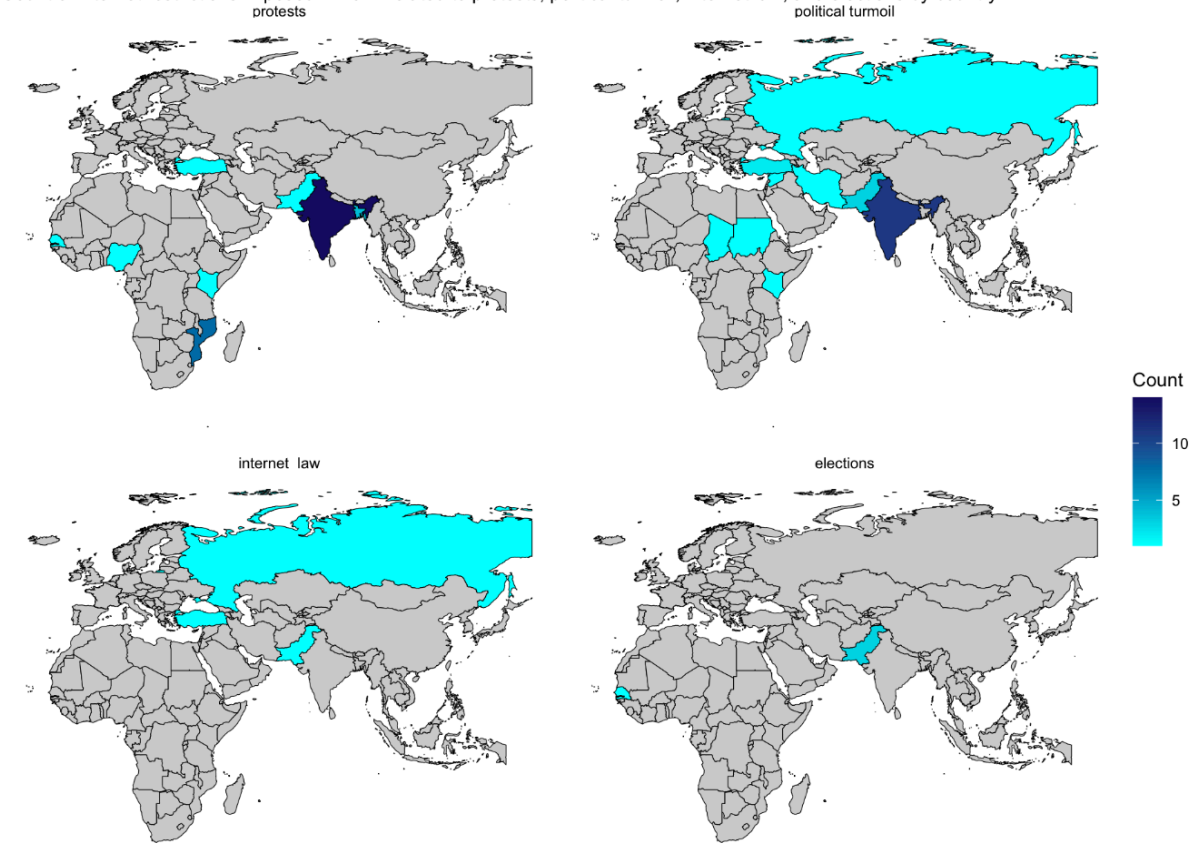
Count of social media restrictions during 2024 by country and app



Source: Surfshark

India's 2024 internet censorships highly related to protests and political turmoil

Count of internet restrictions imposed in 2024 related to protests, political turmoil, internet law, and elections by country



Source: Surfshark